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MONDAY, NOVEMBER 24, 2025

FBI letters rattle Calif. political players

Current and former Newsom aides told they were wiretapped in corruption case

By Laurel Rosenhall
NEW YORK TIMES

SACRAMENTO — California lobbyists soaked in the sun at a Maui resort last week, attending conference sessions about energy and manufacturing in the morning, and relaxing on the beach in the afternoon. For them, it was an annual escape after spending much of the year trying to muscle laws through the state Legislature in Sacramento.

But in between policy discussions, the tropical luxury was occasionally interrupted by the question on everyone's mind:

Patel's use of SWAT teams to guard girlfriend under scrutiny. A2.

Did you get one?
Letters from the FBI landed this month in the mailboxes of California's political class, notifying recipi-

ents that their phone calls and text messages were captured on a wiretap last year. The unwelcome correspondence began to arrive almost immediately after Governor Gavin Newsom's former chief of staff was indicted on 23 felony charges.

The corruption case — and the FBI letters that followed — has sent shivers through Sacramento's close-knit community of lobbyists, government aides, and elected officials.

Many have worked together for decades in a several-block radius around the majestic state Capitol building, drinking at the same wa-

tering holes, dining on clients' tabs, and trading political war stories. Depending on the year, they can be fierce enemies or close allies. They have gone in and out of public service, shaping policy in the nation's most populous state.

Now, just before the holidays, they wonder how far the federal indictment may ripple.

"People are on edge," said Rob Stutzman, a longtime Republican strategist who did not receive a letter and was not involved in the case. "There's a lot of wondering if this is

FBI, Page A7

Ukraine, US report progress on peace plan

Trump again scolds Kyiv amid talks on proposal to end war with Russia

By Cassandra Vinograd and Nick Cumming-Bruce
NEW YORK TIMES

KYIV, Ukraine — Ukrainian and US officials said they had made good progress Sunday in talks about a contentious US plan to end the war with Russia, even as President Trump lashed out at Ukraine, accusing its leaders of ingratitude.

Trump has set a deadline of Thursday for Ukraine to agree to the 28-point peace plan, a draft of which many Ukrainians dismissed as capitulation because it acceded to longstanding Kremlin demands.

The talks, which began in Geneva on Sunday, were cast as an effort to bridge the gaps. At one point, Secretary of State Marco Rubio briefly ducked out of the meetings to tell reporters that the initial discussions had been "productive."

Rubio said the US and Ukrainian teams were working through the peace plan point by point and making adjustments, "narrowing the differences and getting closer to something" that both Kyiv and Washington would be "comfortable with."

He reemerged from the talks about two hours later to say that "tremendous progress" had been made and that he was "very optimistic" a peace plan could be reached "in a very reasonable

UKRAINE, Page A4

Moulton faces 'Markeyverse' of challenges

Confronts senator's strong social media machine

By Anjali Huynh
GLOBE STAFF

Representative Seth Moulton's campaign woke up this month to a pleasant surprise after posting a clip of him on MSNBC to TikTok: He had gone viral.

In the video, Moulton claims President Trump is "obviously in the Epstein files" — "common sense be damned." The video then plays singer Doja Cat's "Paint the Town Red," the lyrics "I said what I said" blasting. The TikTok racked up more than 2.7 million views in a matter of days — more than five times the reach of his next most-popular TikTok.

Moulton, however, may need many more breakout moments if he wants to unseat Senator Ed Markey next year.

The Democratic primary contest between Markey and Moulton is subverting an increasingly familiar political script, involving a young, ambitious candidate challenging an older incumbent in the name of forcing generational change. Unlike New York City's mayoral contest or Maine's Senate race, which have featured younger competitors running to the left of older opponents, Markey, 79, has long enjoyed the backing of

SENATE, Page A7



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

Matt Thomas led the Christmas kids choir in a practice after Mass at Our Lady of Purgatory Church in New Bedford.

In houses of worship, immigrants' fears heard

New Bedford faith leaders see anxiety in city where many are foreign-born

By Omar Mohammed
GLOBE STAFF

NEW BEDFORD — People came here from around the world to work the docks, man whaling ships, process fish, and make textiles in the mills. As waves of immigrants settled on the South Coast, they established places of worship as a way to keep the faith and the culture from their old home.

It's carried on. Today, residents can attend Mass on Sunday and hear hymns in Portuguese, Spanish, or Arabic. They can find peace at a synagogue on a Saturday, or



Choir members shared a page of sheet music as they rehearsed Christmas songs in both English and Arabic at Our Lady of Purgatory Church.

attend prayers at a nearby mosque on Friday.

"You have these all different ethnicities, and you have a church where they have always felt [like] a sanctuary place," said Helena DaSilva Hughes, who runs the Immigrants' Assistance Center in New Bedford.

But since President Trump's stepped-up immigration enforcement began, some faith leaders say anxieties have been running high in the city where a fifth of the population is foreign-born. As reports of detentions of immigrants continue to spread, some in the community live in fear that they could be a target of ICE.

IMMIGRANTS, Page A10

In the news



The Patriots, hampered by injuries, hung on to beat the Cincinnati Bengals, 26-20, for their ninth straight win. **C1.**

Some Harvard students are calling for the university to revoke the tenure of Larry Summers, its former president, over his ties to Jeffrey Epstein. **B1.**

Boston's broadcast journalists are departing TV news, many citing long hours and high stress. **D1.**

Leash-law scofflaws have public growling

Citations, bites rise in Boston as unrestrained dogs menace pedestrians

By Shannon Larson
GLOBE STAFF

On a recent brisk afternoon in Blackstone Square, a sprightly, golden brown dog darted after a tennis ball across yellow leaves, quickly returning the toy to his owner for another round of fetch.

A nearby sign, one of several posted around the South End park, read, "Dogs must remain on leash."

No matter. By the end of the workday, the square had transformed into a gathering place for a community of owners who openly flouted the rule, allowing their dogs to run free.

It's a familiar scene across Boston and beyond, from pocket parks to rolling woods, and few issues are as divisive. For walkers and runners, unleashed dogs can be a dangerous nuisance, while owners tend to downplay the situation, insisting their pet is friendly or disciplined and deserves a chance to roam.

And the number of scofflaws appears to be on the rise.

From 2020 to 2024, the number of off-leash violations in Boston jumped from 298 to 774 — about 160 percent, according to data obtained from the city's Animal Care and Control

DOGS, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/ BOSTON GLOBE STAFF

A dog ran free at Blackstone Square in Boston. From 2020 to 2024, off-leash violations in Boston rose about 160 percent.



Sol delight

Monday: Mostly sunny.
High 46-51, low 33-38.

Tuesday: Mostly sunny.
High 50-55, low 46-51.
Sunrise: 6:46. Sunset: 4:15.
Obituaries, **B6.**
Comics and Weather, **D4-5**

VOL. 308, NO. 147
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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



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